Response: The holddown continues provided that the full-time regular employee who was absent maintains the same assignment and remains absent from the assignment as long as the employee assigned to the holddown remains an unassigned full-time regular or full-time flexible Tractor-Trailer or Motor Vehicle Operator. Unassigned employees that are not on holddowns may bid on duty assignments that are vacant for 10 or more days; in accordance with the provisions outlined in Article 39.1.J.

27. Which employees must possess a Commercial Driver's License (CDL)?

Response: Tractor-Trailer Operators, Motor Vehicle Operators and vehicle maintenance personnel who operate commercial vehicles must possess a CDL. Other Motor Vehicle Craft employees (i.e., body and fender repairman, painters, etc.) are not required to have a CDL except in those situations where the installation has determined that such employees will drive a commercial vehicle off of postal property in the performance of their duties. These employees may continue to be required to drive all types of vehicles on postal property without a CDL.

28. Can Lead Automotive Technicians (PS-09) and/or Lead Automotive Technicians (PS-10) bid on vacant Automotive Technician duty assignments?

Response: Lead Automotive Technicians (PS-09) and Lead Automotive Technicians (PS-10) may not bid on an Automotive Technician position because it is outside their occupational groups. However, such employees may make written application for a residual vacancy for any Motor Vehicle Craft position.

29. How is an Automotive Technician duty assignment filled?

Response: Automotive Technician positions are posted for bid to Level 7 employees who are automotive technician qualified and current automotive technicians, with the position(s) awarded on a senior basis among the qualified bidders.

30. How is a vacant Lead Automotive Technician (PS-10) duty assignment filled?

Response: It is posted for bid to all current Lead Automotive Technicians (PS-09) and Lead Automotive Technicians (PS-10), and is awarded to the senior Lead Automotive Technician bidder, regardless of level. If the posting does not result in a successful bidder, the position is filled on a best qualified basis within the motor vehicle craft.

31. When all motor vehicle maintenance duty assignments are posted pursuant to Article 39.2.A.7, can Automotive Mechanics and Automotive Technicians compete with each other for positions, and can the Lead Automotive Technician (PS-09) and Lead Automotive Technician (PS-10) compete with each other for positions?

Response: Article 39.2.A.8 provides that employees bidding pursuant to Article 39.2.A.6&7 may bid only on those duty assignments that have the same position designation. Therefore, Automotive Mechanics can only bid on Automotive Mechanic duty assignments, Automotive Technicians can only bid Automotive